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W E D N E S D A Y , M A Y 7 , 2 0 2 5

Kraft sees opening in Black areas

While some voters are disaffected, Wu points to successes

By Niki Griswold and Tiana Woodard
GLOBE STAFF

On the corner of Zeigler and Warren streets in Roxbury, a bright yellow flag on a street lamp reads “Nubian Square, The Heart & Soul of Roxbury.” At the bottom, like many city signs, it bears the name of Mayor Michelle Wu.

Recently, another set of signs has sprouted a few feet away: blue and white “Josh Kraft 2025 Democrat for Mayor” posters, which plaster the windows of the mayoral candidate’s new campaign headquarters.

It’s no coincidence that Kraft chose to base his campaign to unseat Wu in Roxbury, “the heart of Black Boston,” and one of the city’s most diverse and historically disenfranchised neighborhoods. The location is just down the road from the Roxbury branch of the Boys & Girls Club, where Kraft developed deep community relationships in the three decades he worked there, including 12 as its president and chief executive.

“This couldn’t be a more appropriate place for our campaign to call home,” Kraft said in March at the opening of his campaign HQ. “This campaign is about making sure that every voice in Boston is heard and valued.”

KRAFT, Page A5

State lawmakers are renewing calls for action against Ralph de la Torre, a year after Steward Health Care filed for bankruptcy protection. **B5.**

The Trump administration can start enforcing a ban on transgender troops in the military, the Supreme Court ruled. **A2.**

Alcatraz is in terrible shape and there’s little support for reopening the prison, despite President Trump’s wishes. **A2.**

It’s only Game 2, but it’s a must-win for the Celtics tonight, writes Chad Finn. **C1.**



A bond in the kitchen

Amarilys Colón, now the executive chef at La Padrona in Back Bay, got her love for cooking from her mother, Gladys Rivera. **G1.**



Puddling through

Wednesday: Not as wet. High 66-71. Low 54-59.
Thursday: Some sun. High 69-73. Low 46-51.
Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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At Harvard, a scramble for funding

Researchers forced to look beyond US grants after threat

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

What would Harvard University be without the money the federal government has provided over decades to underwrite its vast research initiatives?

That’s the existential, \$9 billion question facing the Harvard commu-

nity after the Trump administration’s most recent threat in its confrontation with the university: Harvard will not receive any new federal research grants unless and until it complies with White House demands.

This is the second disruption to federally funded research work at Harvard in as many months, following a freeze of \$2.2 billion in April after the university said it would not agree to a raft of White House demands on everything from hiring and admissions practices to disciplinary matters involving international stu-

dents.

“Instead of working on things that had previously been funded, now it’s a question of, OK, we need to find money to fund that same research for the second time,” said Adam Sychla, a Harvard Medical School postdoctoral research fellow working on a team developing programmable treatments for everything from cancer to the common cold.

“It slows down research progress, which means that any of the technologies we develop are going to take longer to come to people,” Sychla add-

ed, “which is who it’s ultimately for — it’s for the public.”

On Monday, Education Secretary Linda McMahon disclosed the latest cutoff in a letter to Harvard president Alan Garber. “Harvard should no longer seek GRANTS from the federal government, since none will be provided,” McMahon wrote in the May 5 letter, citing “ugly racism in its undergraduate and graduate schools” as being among a long list of “violations.”

Trump’s latest ultimatum about future grants, while not exactly a surprise, was not unexpected.

HARVARD, Page A6

Carney: “As you know from real estate, there are some places that are never for sale.”

Trump: “Never say never.”

Carney mouths “never.”



ERIC LEE/NEW YORK TIMES)

Mark Carney, Canada’s prime minister, met with President Trump at the White House on Tuesday and made it clear his country will not become the 51st state, despite what Trump has floated. The president did take a more conciliatory tone in their meeting, and praised Carney for his election. **A4.**

Victimized by DOGE, they dream of turning the tables

Terminated federal workers explore running for office

By Julian E.J. Sorapur
GLOBE STAFF

Shernice Mundell has always been interested in politics, but she preferred to be active behind the scenes: phone banking, making modest campaign donations, writing letters to elected officials — that was how she stayed engaged.

Now, the 47-year-old Maryland resident is seriously considering stepping into the bright lights of public office.

Her motivation?

Mundell, formerly a health insurance specialist for the Office of Personnel Management, was one of thousands

of federal employees who were let go on Feb. 13 as part of the Trump administration and Department of Government Efficiency’s downsizing.

Though Mundell “cried a lot” that day, there is a silver lining. “I probably would have never pursued going into politics if this wouldn’t have happened to me,” she said.

For the last year, Mundell said, she’s been “asking God to show me my purpose.” She sees her termination from the personnel management office as a sign she needed “to run for office and to make a change.” She’s considering several offices, but favors a Democratic

congressional bid.

“I can’t just say I want things to change and not actively try to change it,” said Mundell, who had been working for the office since August.

With more than 120,000 federal jobs eliminated since President Trump took office in January, Democrats are making a push to transform more civil servants into politicians.

Cheri Bustos, a retired US representative from Illinois who chaired the House Democrats’ campaign arm, said former federal workers are well-positioned to make the transition to public

WORKERS, Page A7

Taking credit where it isn’t due

Trump touts investments Biden pushed

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Six weeks into his second term, President Trump stood with the chief executive of the Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company to announce another example of what his administration calls “the Trump effect” — trillions of private investment dollars pouring into the United States since his inauguration.

TSMC, the world’s largest computer chip maker, pledged that day in the White House to spend \$100 billion to expand its factory complex in Arizona to a total of six fabrication facilities. Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick said the huge financial commitment was because of Trump’s leadership and tariffs.

“This continues the most incredible path you’ve ever seen of incredible manufacturing coming to America,” Lutnick said at the March 3 event.

But like some other “Trump effect” investments, Trump doesn’t deserve all the credit.

TSMC said it had already spent \$65 billion in Arizona over the past five years to build two fabrication facilities on its sprawling Phoenix campus and was weeks from breaking ground on a third

INVESTMENTS, Page A7

Who’s to thank?

TSMC | \$100 billion pledged: Arizona factory expansion received \$6.6 billion grant from CHIPS

Roche Genentech | \$50 billion invested: Boston innovation center planned since early 2024

Stellantis | \$1.2 billion pledged: Illinois factory came out of 2023 union contract and follows \$334 million Biden administration grant

Developers point finger at housing rule

Affordable units cutting into slim profits, they say

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — By now, the parking lot at 2400 Mass. Ave. was supposed to be full of construction workers, building 60 condominiums a quick walk from the Red Line.

But nearly a year since the project’s developers — the local group North Cambridge Partners — finished their trudge through city permit-

ting, this patch of prime real estate is still just a sparse storefront and a lot scattered with vehicles.

Why? Despite its location on a main thoroughfare in one of the strongest housing markets in the world, the project won’t make enough money to attract investors who will pay to build it, and the developers say a key city affordable housing policy is to blame.

Cambridge is one of many local communities that require most new housing developments to include units set aside at below-market rents — in its case, 20 percent of the

building, which is among the highest rates in Greater Boston — with the intention of creating more affordable homes in a city that is starved for them.

But housing is so expensive to build right now that some developers say that this so-called inclusionary housing requirement may be backfiring, making otherwise profitable projects too costly to build and stopping them before shovels hit the ground. Put another way, a policy aimed at generating affordable housing may actually be preventing it.

HOUSING, Page A10



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Cities are loath to ease their affordable housing requirements, even if doing so could generate more units.